

Chapter

Gau Seva — A Practice of Gratitude, Purity and Prosperity



Introduction: Our Debt to Mother Cow

In Indian life the cow is not merely an animal; she is a mother. This account of the Gau Seva (service to cows) organised by the Antar Yog Foundation under the guidance of Sadguru Acharya Upendra Ji begins in exactly this spirit:

"Gau Mata, whose selfless contribution has blessed human life — the scriptures and the saints and great souls have declared her importance to be supreme."

"Especially in our Bharat, which for centuries has been a land of agriculture, the cow is worshipped in the form of a mother."

That is why Gau Seva is not an optional act of merit, but a duty:

"Gau Mata is the foundation stone of our culture, and Gau Seva is the foremost duty of every Indian."

The Priceless Contribution of Mother Cow

Mother Cow's contribution runs through our food, our health and our livelihood alike:

"From milk, curd, ghee, cow urine and medicines to farming, organic production and the livelihood of lakhs of people, her contribution is priceless."

When we have received so much from someone, it is only natural to express our thanks. Gau Seva is the means of that thanks:

"Antar Yog offers you a priceless opportunity to express your **gratitude and thankfulness** to Gau Mata through Gau Seva."

"Under the divine guidance of Sadguru Acharya Upendra Ji, the Antar Yog Foundation organises Gau Seva from time to time, so that all of us together can nurture this divine heritage."

A Source of Prosperity and Good Fortune

By tradition, Mother Cow is regarded as a symbol of Lakshmi — that is, of prosperity:

"Gau Mata is regarded as a symbol of wealth, prosperity and abundance. It is believed that serving Gau Mata brings, all at once, the blessings of the **thirty-three crore gods and goddesses** and immense merit."

But this fruit comes not from the act alone, but from the **bhav**, the inner feeling:

"By serving Gau Mata **with the right feeling**, we attract prosperity and good fortune into our aura."

Abhamandal — the subtle energy field around a person (the aura). The pure feeling of service purifies and enriches this very field.

The Scriptural Way: Feeling, Not Mechanical Routine

How the service is done matters as much as doing it:

"Acharya Upendra Ji teaches the proper, scripturally sanctioned way of Gau Seva, so that by experiencing Gau Mata's **motherly, loving energy** we are able to attract prosperity and good fortune, and find peace of mind and joy."

At the heart of this method is seeing God in the cow:

"Acharya Ji says that Gau Seva should be done **not mechanically**, but by seeing a part of the Supreme Lord in the cows, with the feeling of 'Om Tat Sat'."

Om Tat Sat is the threefold name of the Supreme Brahman; every action done while remembering it becomes an offering to God:

**om tat sad iti nirdeśo brahmaṇas tri-vidhaḥ
smṛtaḥ**

"Om, Tat and Sat — these are declared to be the
threefold designation of Brahman."

— Bhagavad Gita 17.23

"With this very feeling, the team of sevaks offers every
act of service to Gau Mata **with love**."

The Place of Service and the Experience of Motherly Love

The place for the service is also chosen with care:

"In Antar Yog, a place is chosen for Gau Seva where the
cow is truly honoured as a mother — a vast place where
hundreds of Gau Matas and their little calves live."

There, the exchange of love and affection can be seen directly:

"When Acharya Ji and Guru Maa lovingly stroke Gau Mata and feed her fodder, the whole herd, as if recognising their divinity, becomes eager for their closeness, and the calves come forward again and again, longing to receive their affection."

This experience is open to every participant:

"Everyone gets the opportunity to experience this affection of Gau Mata, and also the opportunity to **feed Gau Mata with their own hands.**"

The Gaushala: A Place Where Sadhana Bears a Thousandfold Fruit

The gaushala (cow shelter) is a place not only of service but also of spiritual practice:

"The special quality of Gau Seva done with Acharya Upendra Ji and Antar Yog is this — special sadhana performed in a sacred place such as a gaushala, which bears a **thousandfold fruit**; so it is said in our scriptures."

Sahasra guna — a thousandfold. Japa and meditation done in a sacred place yield many times the fruit of the same practice done in an ordinary place.

Service Is Never Complete

In words spoken at the gaushala during the service, there is a humble reminder that our service to Gau Mata can never be "enough":

"Don't think that however much service we do, it is enough. It has to be done — give them medicine, give them water, clean everything. Even after doing that, it is still too little."

In the same spirit, those who carry out this service day after day are also remembered:

"We express heartfelt gratitude to the dedicated staff of the gaushala, through whose devotion and service this Sanatan tradition is still alive today."

"Gau Seva is the root of our life and culture; it is the **essential duty** of every human being."

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1** Gau Mata is the foundation stone of our culture, and Gau Seva is the foremost duty of every Indian.
- 2** From milk, ghee, cow urine and medicine to farming and livelihoods, Gau Mata's contribution is priceless; Gau Seva is the means of expressing our **gratitude** for it.
- 3** Gau Seva done with the right feeling attracts **prosperity and good fortune into our aura** and gives the mind peace and joy.
- 4** Gau Seva should be done **not mechanically**, but by seeing a part of the Supreme Lord in the cows, with the feeling of "Om Tat Sat".

- 5 Sadhana performed in a sacred place like a gaushala bears a **thousandfold fruit**.
- 6 However much we serve, it is too little — and gratitude toward those who carry out this service every day is also part of the seva.